

Miya Zhao

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EDUCATION

Yale University *B.S. Statistics and Data Science & Certificate in Programming (GPA: 3.79/4.00)* **Aug 2023 - May 2027**

- *Coursework:* Data Structures and Programming, Machine Learning, Multivariate Statistics, Data Exploration & Analysis, Linear Models, Theory of Statistics/Probability, Language & Computation, Research Inquiry & Presentation

London School of Economics and Political Science

June 2025 - Aug 2025

- *Coursework:* Computational Methods in Financial Mathematics, Introduction to Data Science & Machine Learning

PROJECTS/RESEARCH

Yale-Maps

Sep 2025 – Present

Creator | Product Lead & Developer

- Built Yale Maps with Node.js and Mapbox, motivated by the need to centralize fragmented campus information and improve access to study spaces, transit, and safety resources.
- Designed user-focused features and dynamic data pipelines, including real-time shuttle tracking, campus events, and location-aware recommendations for accessibility and AEDs.

Yale Systems Biology Institute — Farren Isaacs Lab

Dec 2023 – Jan 2026

Student Researcher | International Genetically Engineered Machine (iGEM) Team President

- Led a cross-functional research team to develop a novel protein functionalization approach using non-standard amino acids, aligning technical development with therapeutic use cases of L-asparaginase, used in pediatric chemotherapy
- Built a logistic-regression based modeling tool to optimize experimental workflows and reduce iteration cost
- Designed and launched a global human-practices initiative on science funding and public trust in synthetic biology, engaging stakeholders across 4 continents and 7 countries
- Managed \$48K+ budget and secured \$10K+ in in-kind industry partnerships (Abcam, NEB, Twist, IDT)
- Guided Yale to its first Gold Medal in 15 years at the 2025 Annual iGEM Jamboree in Paris

EXPERIENCE

Yale Asian American Cultural Center

Aug 2024 – Present

Undergraduate Student Coordinator | Historical, Artistic, and Cultural Resources Team

- Planned and executed large-scale programs for 300+ attendees, boosting engagement across Yale's Pan-Asian population.
- Conceptualized and launched a new student arts space, managing design and logistics to opening event execution.
- Built cross-campus collaborations by connecting cultural centers, the Yale School of Music, the School of Art, and student artists to deliver innovative, co-curated programming.

Yale Hunger and Homelessness Action Project

Sep 2023 - May 2025

FAST Digital Marketing Lead | Digital Team Designer

- Created the digital strategy for Yale's largest fundraising initiative, raising \$33K+ for New Haven housing and food insecurity efforts; the creative campaigns drove 2,700+ sign-ups, the highest participation since pre-COVID

LEADERSHIP/ACTIVITIES

Yale Computer Society

Sep 2025 - Present

- Selected as 1 of 50 Catalyst mentees, studying frontend and backend design to strengthen full-stack development skills.
- Developing an Incubator project, designing apps and APIs with scalable, secure functionality with Yale security standards.

Yale Chinese American Students Association

Sep 2023 - Dec 2025

President | Cultural Chair

- Led one of Yale's largest student organizations (900+ members, \$10K+ budget), setting direction and coordinating programming across the academic year with a 25-member board
- Delivered 20+ events per semester, including large-scale cultural showcases and celebrations (200+ attendees)

SKILLS

Technical: Python, R (dplyr), SQL, Jira, C, JavaScript (React, Vite), Docker, Mapbox GL JS, Adobe Creative Cloud, Prism, Git

Certifications: Microsoft Office Specialist (Excel, PowerPoint, Word), ACT WorkKeys (Platinum)

Languages: English (Native), Mandarin Chinese (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate)